



**Solution:**

1. **D. 24**

Note:

$$\log_a b = \frac{\log_b b}{\log_b a} = \frac{1}{\log_b a}$$

Thus,

$$\log_a 2 + \log_a 3 + \log_a 4 = 1$$

$$\log_a 24 = 1$$

$$a = 24$$

2. **C. 0.25**

$$\log[k(x+y)] = \frac{1}{2}(\log x + \log y)$$

$$2\log[k(x+y)] = \log x + \log y$$

$$\log[k(x+y)]^2 = \log(xy)$$

$$[k(x+y)]^2 = xy$$

$$k^2(x+y)^2 = xy$$

$$x^2 + 2xy + y^2 = \frac{xy}{k^2}$$

$$x^2 + y^2 = \frac{xy}{k^2} - 2xy$$

$$x^2 + y^2 = \left(\frac{1}{k^2} - 2\right)xy$$

So, from  $x^2 + y^2 = 14xy$ :

$$14xy = \left(\frac{1}{k^2} - 2\right)xy$$

$$14 = \frac{1}{k^2} - 2$$

$$\frac{1}{k^2} = 16$$

$$k = \pm \frac{1}{4}$$

3. **C. 2**

If the roots are 3 and 2, then:

$$Ax^2 + Bx + C = 0$$

$$(x-3)(x-2) = 0$$

$$x^2 - 5x + 6 = 0$$

$$A + B + C = 1 - 5 + 6$$

$$A + B + C = 2$$

4. **D. 2/3**

$$2\log_a x - \log_a(x-1) - \log_a(x-2) = 0$$

$$\log_a \frac{x^2}{(x-1)(x-2)} = 0$$

$$\frac{x^2}{x^2 - 3x + 2} = a^0$$

$$x = \frac{2}{3}$$

5. **B. 90**

$$15 = 5 \cdot 3$$

$$18 = 6 \cdot 3$$

$$\text{LCM} = 5 \cdot 6 \cdot 3 = 90$$

6. **B. 25 + k**

$$p - q = 5$$

By squaring both sides:

$$(p-q)^2 = 5^2$$

$$p^2 - 2pq + q^2 = 25$$

$$p^2 + q^2 = 25 + 2pq$$

$$p^2 + q^2 = 25 + 2\left(\frac{k}{2}\right)$$

$$p^2 + q^2 = 25 + k$$

7. **D. 4**

$$x^2 + 2(k+2)x + 9k = 0$$

For equal roots  $B^2 - 4AC = 0$

$$x^2 + 2(k+2)x + 9k = 0$$

$$B^2 - 4AC = 0$$

$$(2k+4)^2 - 4(1)(9k) = 0$$

$$4k^2 - 20k + 16 = 0$$

$$k_1 = 4; k_2 = 1$$

8. **A. 3**

$$3x^2 - kx + x - 7k = 0$$

At  $x = 3$ ,

$$3(3)^2 - k(3) + 3 - 7k = 0$$

$$k = 3$$

9. **B. 1:2**

$$\frac{1}{x} : \frac{1}{y} \rightarrow \frac{1}{x} \div \frac{1}{y} = \frac{y}{x}$$

$$2x + 4y = 7x - 6y$$

$$y(4+6) = x(7-2)$$

$$\frac{y}{x} = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\frac{1}{x} : \frac{1}{y} \rightarrow 1:2$$

10. **B. xy**

$$\frac{(xy)^n (a-b)^{-1} (a-b)^{2n-1}}{[xy(a-b)^2]^{n-1}}$$

$$\frac{(xy)^n \left(\frac{1}{a-b}\right) (a-b)^{2n} (a-b)^{-1}}{(xy)^n (xy)^{-1} (a-b)^{2n-2}}$$

$$\frac{(a-b)^{2n}}{(a-b)^2}$$

$$\left(\frac{1}{xy}\right) (a-b)^{2n} (a-b)^{-2}$$

$$\frac{xy(a-b)^2}{(a-b)^2} = xy$$

11. **B. 12 days**

Wife's day off: 4<sup>th</sup> day

Husband's day off: 6<sup>th</sup> day

Getting the least common multiple of 4 and 6

$$\text{LCM} = 12$$

12. **A. 43,750x^8**

Binomial Expansion:

Total number of terms =  $n + 1$

$$(x^2 - 5)^8; n = 8$$

Number of terms = 9

Middle term = 5<sup>th</sup> term

$$\text{Nth Term} = {}_n C_{r-1} a^{n-r+1} b^{r-1}$$

$$5^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = {}_8 C_{5-1} (x^2)^{8-5+1} (-5)^{5-1}$$

$$5^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = 43,750x^8$$

13. **A. 2**

Applying Factor Theorem

If  $\frac{f(x)}{x-k}$ ; Remainder =  $f(x) = 0$

Then,

$$\frac{kx^2 - 6x + 2kx - 12}{x-3}$$

$$\text{Remainder} = f(x) = 0$$

$$\text{At } x = 3$$

$$kx^2 - 6x + 2kx - 12 = 0$$

$$k(3)^2 - 6(3) + 2k(3) - 12 = 0$$

$$k = 2$$



14. C. - 5

Applying Remainder Theorem

If  $\frac{f(x)}{x-k}$ ; Remainder =  $f(x)$

Then,

$$\frac{x^4 + ax^3 + 5x^2 + bx + 6}{x - 2}$$

Remainder =  $f(x) = 16$  at  $x = 2$

$$x^4 + ax^3 + 5x^2 + bx + 6 = 16$$

$$(2)^4 + a(2)^3 + 5(2)^2 + b(2) + 6 = 16$$

$$8a + 2b = -26 \rightarrow \text{eqn 1}$$

When,

$$\frac{x^4 + ax^3 + 5x^2 + bx + 6}{x + 1}$$

Remainder =  $f(x) = 10$  at  $x = -1$

$$x^4 + ax^3 + 5x^2 + bx + 6 = 10$$

$$\left( (-1)^4 + a(-1)^3 + 5(-1)^2 + b(-1) + 6 \right) = 10$$

$$-a - b = -2 \rightarrow \text{eqn 2}$$

Solving for a and b:

$$a = -5 \text{ and } b = 7$$

15. C. -  $280(a^4)(x^3)$

$$(a - 2x)^7$$

$$\text{rth Term} = {}_nC_{r-1} a^{n-r+1} b^{r-1}$$

$$4^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = {}_7C_{4-1} a^{7-4+1} (-2x)^{4-1}$$

$$4^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = -280a^4 x^3$$

16. B.  $25,344x^9$

$$\text{rth Term} = {}_nC_{r-1} a^{n-r+1} b^{r-1}$$

$$\text{rth Term} = {}_{12}C_{r-1} (x^2)^{12-r+1} \left( \frac{2}{x} \right)^{r-1}$$

Considering the terms w/  $x$  for  $x^9$ :

$$(x^2)^{12-r+1} (x^{-1})^{r-1} = x^9$$

$$2(12-r+1) + (-1)(r-1) = 9$$

$$24 - 2r + 2 - r + 1 = 9$$

$$r = 6$$

$$6^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = {}_{12}C_{6-1} (x^2)^{12-6+1} \left( \frac{2}{x} \right)^{6-1}$$

$$6^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = 25,344x^9$$

17. A. 1

$$x = (\log_c a)(\log_a b)(\log_b c)$$

$$x = \left( \frac{\log a}{\log c} \right) \left( \frac{\log b}{\log a} \right) \left( \frac{\log c}{\log b} \right) = 1$$

18. B. 256

$$(x + 2y - z)^8$$

Sum of Coefficients = (let all variables to 1)<sup>n</sup>

$$\text{Sum of Coefficients} = (1+2-1)^8$$

$$\text{Sum of Coefficients} = 256$$

19. B. e and e<sup>5</sup>

$$(\ln x)^2 - 2 \ln x^3 = -5$$

$$(\ln x)^2 - 6 \ln x = -5$$

$$\text{Let } A = \ln x$$

$$A^2 - 6A + 5 = 0$$

$$A_1 = 5 ; A_2 = 1$$

$$\text{At } A = 5,$$

$$\text{At } A = 1$$

$$\ln x = 5$$

$$\ln x = 5$$

$$x = e^5$$

$$x = e$$

20. A. 21

$$x : y : z = 2 : 5 : 7$$

$$\frac{x}{y} = \frac{2}{5}$$

$$5x - 2y = 0 \rightarrow \text{eqn 1}$$

$$\frac{y}{z} = \frac{5}{7}$$

$$7y - 5z = 0 \rightarrow \text{eqn 2}$$

$$4x - y + 2z = 51 \rightarrow \text{eqn 3}$$

$$x = 6, y = 15 \text{ and } z = 21$$

21. C. -  $66339/128a^{11}$

$$\text{Binomial Expansion} \left( \frac{1}{2} - 3 \right)^{16}$$

$$\text{rth Term} = {}_nC_{r-1} a^{n-r+1} b^{r-1}$$

where,  $n = 16$

$$6^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = {}_{16}C_{6-1} \left( \frac{1}{2a} \right)^{16-6+1} (-3)^{6-1}$$

$$6^{\text{th}} \text{ Term} = -\frac{66339}{128a^{11}}$$

22. D.  $y = xb^{2x}$

$$\log_b y = 2x + \log_b x$$

$$\log_b y - \log_b x = 2x$$

$$\frac{\log_{10} y}{\log_{10} b} - \frac{\log_{10} x}{\log_{10} b} = 2x$$

$$\log_{10} y - \log_{10} x = 2x \log_{10} b$$

$$\log_{10} \frac{y}{x} = \log_{10} b^{2x}$$

$$y = xb^{2x}$$

23. A. 20

$$(x + y + z)^5$$

Trinomial Expansion

$$\text{rth Term} = \frac{n!}{p!q!s!} (a)^p (b)^q (c)^s$$

where,  $n = p + q + s$

Identifying the term with  $xy^3z$ :

$$\frac{5!}{p!q!s!} (x)^p (y)^q (z)^s$$

$$x^p = x; p = 1$$

$$y^q = y^3; q = 3$$

$$z^s = z; s = 1$$

$$\text{Thus for coefficient, } \frac{5!}{1!3!1!} = 20$$

24. A. 78

$$\text{Binomial Expansion} (x^a + y^b)^n$$

$$\text{Sum of exponents: } n(n+1) \left( \frac{a+b}{2} \right)$$

$$\text{Then, } \left( x^2 + \frac{2}{x} \right)^{12}$$

$$12(12+1) \left( \frac{2+(-1)}{2} \right) = 78$$

25. A.  $n(n+1)^2$

$$\frac{[(n+1)!]^2}{n!(n-1)!} = \frac{[(n+1-1)!(n+1)]^2}{n!(n-1)!}$$

$$= \frac{(n!)^2 (n+1)^2}{n!(n-1)!}$$

$$= \frac{(n+1)^2 (n)(n-1)!}{(n-1)!}$$

$$= n(n+1)^2$$

"Successful people do what unsuccessful people are not willing to do."